

WHY DID JESUS GIVE HIMSELF FOR US?

The Cross and Everything Standing Between Us and God

The obedient Son willingly gave Himself to bear sin's judgment, answer God's righteous wrath, reclaim sinners, make peace, and bring them to God.



BIG IDEA

The cross is one coherent saving accomplishment with many complementary dimensions.

KEY SCRIPTURE

1 Peter 3:18

ALSO READ

Romans 3:21-26

MEMORY VERSE

1 PETER 3:18a

"For Christ also hath once suffered for sins, the just for the unjust, that he might bring us to God..."

MAIN QUESTION

What Did Christ Accomplish Through His Death?

45 MINUTES

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SESSION SNAPSHOT



SESSION GOALS

- See Christ's death as one saving act, not competing theories.
- Understand the purpose: to bring sinners to God.
- Distinguish six dimensions without separating them.
- Recognize the Father's and Son's united saving purpose.

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OPENING ACTIVITY: "WHAT STANDS BETWEEN US?"

- DRAW THE SEPARATION (2 MIN)**
Write GOD on one side of the board and SINNERS on the other. Draw a wide barrier between them.

- NAME THE BARRIERS (2 MIN)**
Review Session 3. Write guilt, judgment and death, estrangement, and bondage inside the barrier.

- ASK WHAT EACH REQUIRES (2 MIN)**
Guilt must be removed. Judgment must be borne. Captives must be reclaimed. Enemies must be made at peace. Separation must be overcome.

- READ THE PURPOSE (2 MIN)**
Read 1 Peter 3:18. Circle "the just for the unjust" and underline "that he might bring us to God." The cross answers every barrier toward one end.

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LEADER GUARDRAIL

Do not portray the Father as hostile and the Son as loving, or Christ as a reluctant victim. Father, Son, and Spirit act in one saving purpose. Christ willingly gives Himself; He remains the sinless Son while bearing sin's judgment.

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PREPARE

- Bible
- Board or paper
- Two colored markers
- Student handouts
- Review Sessions 3-5

The just One gave Himself for the unjust in order to bring us to God.

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CORE TEACHING

1

CHRIST WILLINGLY STANDS FOR SINNERS

1 Pet. 3:18

The just One gives Himself for the unjust. He is not a third party forced into another's dispute, but the obedient Son acting with the Father to save.

EMPHASIZE: Substitution is personal, willing, and purposeful.

2

CHRIST BEARS JUDGMENT

Rom. 3:21-26

God's wrath is His holy opposition to rebellion, not uncontrolled temper. The sinless Son bears judgment for sinners and answers God's righteous wrath.

EMPHASIZE: Penal substitution is substitution unto propitiation.

3

CHRIST REMOVES CLAIMS AND MAKES PEACE

Eph. 1:7

Forgiveness removes guilt; redemption reclaims those under bondage; reconciliation establishes real peace and restored relationship with God.

EMPHASIZE: These are complementary results of the same cross.

4

CHRIST BRINGS US TO GOD

1 Pet. 3:18

Atonement is the uniting work of Christ. The cross does not distribute detached benefits; it removes every obstacle so those who trust Christ may share life with God in Him.

EMPHASIZE: Communion in Christ is the goal.

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DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1

What does 'the just for the unjust' mean?

Follow-up: What makes Christ a true substitute?

2

Why is God's wrath not the same as human temper?

Follow-up: What does His holy opposition answer?

3

How do substitution and propitiation differ?

Follow-up: How does the first lead to the second?

4

Why is reconciliation more than a truce?

Follow-up: What relationship does Christ establish?

5

What purpose does 1 Peter 3:18 name?

Follow-up: Why is this larger than receiving benefits?

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WEEKLY REFLECTION

Read Isaiah 53 and 1 Peter 3:18. List what Christ does and why He does it.

- What barriers does His work answer?
- Am I seeking His benefits while keeping my own authority?

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PRIVATE CONVERSATION

Do not offer automatic reassurance. Return the student to the crucified and risen Person: saving faith entrusts the whole self to Jesus Christ.

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LEADER NOTES

- One saving work.
- Christ remains sinless.
- No division in the Trinity.
- No automatic universal reception.
- Point ahead to resurrection.

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ONE CROSS - MANY DIMENSIONS

SUBSTITUTION

Just for unjust

SACRIFICE

He gives Himself

PROPIATION

Judgment answered

REDEMPTION

Captives reclaimed

RECONCILIATION

Peace established

ATONEMENT

Brought to God

The cross removes every obstacle in order to bring sinners home to God in Christ.